Chips

Chips help people enter information, make selections, filter content, or trigger actions

Resources +2

Use cases

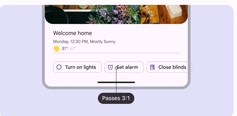
People should be able to do the following with assistive technology:

- Use a chip to perform an action
- Navigate to a chip
- Activate a chip

Interaction & style

The chip label needs at least 3:1 contrast with the background.

A chip that performs an action should present the same semantics as a button to a platform's accessibility API.

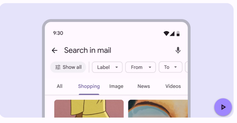


High contrast helps differentiate chips clustered together

Horizontal overflow

When there are too many chips to fit on one row, provide a way to display them all at once and avoid scrolling.

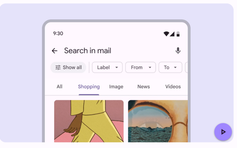
Reflow method: Use a filter chip as a leading element to reflow the horizontal list. This should shift down the content below and make room for all chips to show.



The **Show all** filter chip is used to reflow the list, displaying all chips at once and pushing down the content below

Menu method: Create a leading button to display all chip options in a menu. Use this option to avoid shifting the position of the content below.

Don't use the menu method on chips with a second action, like a remove icon.



The **Show all** leading button shows a menu of chip options, keeping the place of content below

Avoid applying density by default

Don't apply density to chips by default — this lowers their targets below our best practice of 48x48 CSS pixels. Instead, give people a way to choose a higher density, like selecting a denser layout or changing the theme.

To ensure that this density setting can be easily reverted when it's active, keep all the targets to change it at minimum 48x48 CSS pixels each.

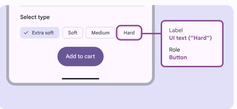
Keyboard navigation

Keys	Actions
Tab	Moves focus to enabled chip or chip group
Space or **Enter**	Activates, selects, or deselects the focused chip
Backspace or **Delete**	Removes currently focused input chip
Arrows	Moves focus between chips

Labeling elements

Element	A11y label	Role (Web)	Role (MDC-Android)	Role (Jetpack Compose)
Image / Icon within chip	Hide image	-	-	-
Basic chip (one action)	"{chip content}"	gridcell	button	button
Selectable chip	"{chip content}"	gridcell	radio button	checkbox
Remove icon (no other action)	"Remove {chip content}"	-	-	-
Two actions (e.g., select + remove)	"{chip content}." Then "Remove {chip content}".	button or checkbox	button or checkbox	button or checkbox

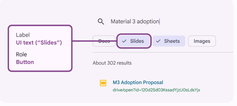
The accessibility label for a chip is the chip's label text. Additional actions, like remove, are labeled separately.



Accessibility tags should include both the label and role

Multi-select

For multi-select chip sets, **Space** or **Enter** will select the focused chip and allow you to select all of the chips. **Space** or **Enter** will also deselect a focused selected chip.

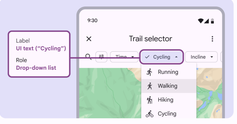


While multiple chips can be selected, only one can be in focus

Drop-down list

The accessibility label should align with each list item's text label.

For list items with text and an icon, the accessibility label should be marked as decorative to avoid redundant verbalizations.



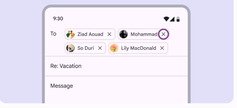
The accessibility label should be the text label

Input chip remove action

Display the remove icon whenever a chip can be removed. On mobile, if remove is the only chip action, the remove icon isn't necessary. Instead the chip can be removed by selecting it and pressing the **Delete** key on the keyboard.

Each chip is a focusable element.

- If a chip only has a remove icon, the entire chip and icon are one focusable element.
- If a chip has a second action, like select, then the chip content and remove icon are two separate focusable elements.



The remove action is focused when the chip can also be selected